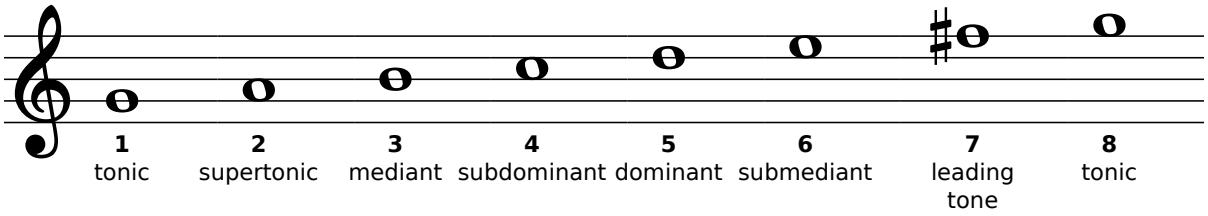
Tonic, Scale Degrees, and Key

Chapter 12 built major scales from the pattern W W H W W W H. Each note of a scale has a number, counted up from the tonic. A **scale degree** is the position of a note in its scale: the tonic is degree 1, the next note is degree 2, and so on up to degree 7. The note an octave above the tonic is the tonic again, sometimes numbered 8.

Each degree also has a name. The three most important are the **tonic** (1), the home note of the key; the **dominant** (5), the strongest note after the tonic; and the **subdominant** (4), one step below the dominant. The **leading tone** (7) lies a half step below the tonic and leads up to it.

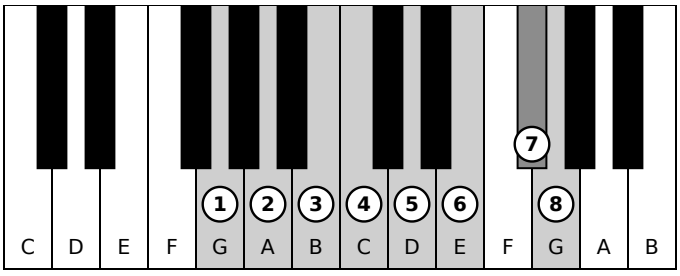


The G major scale with degree numbers and names.

Degree	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Name	tonic	supertonic	mediant	subdominant	dominant	submediant	leading tone
In G major	G	A	B	C	D	E	F♯

Degrees on the keyboard

The degree numbers stay the same in every major key; only the letter names change. In G major, degree 7 is F♯, a half step below G.



G major: degree numbers on the keys.

Key and tonic

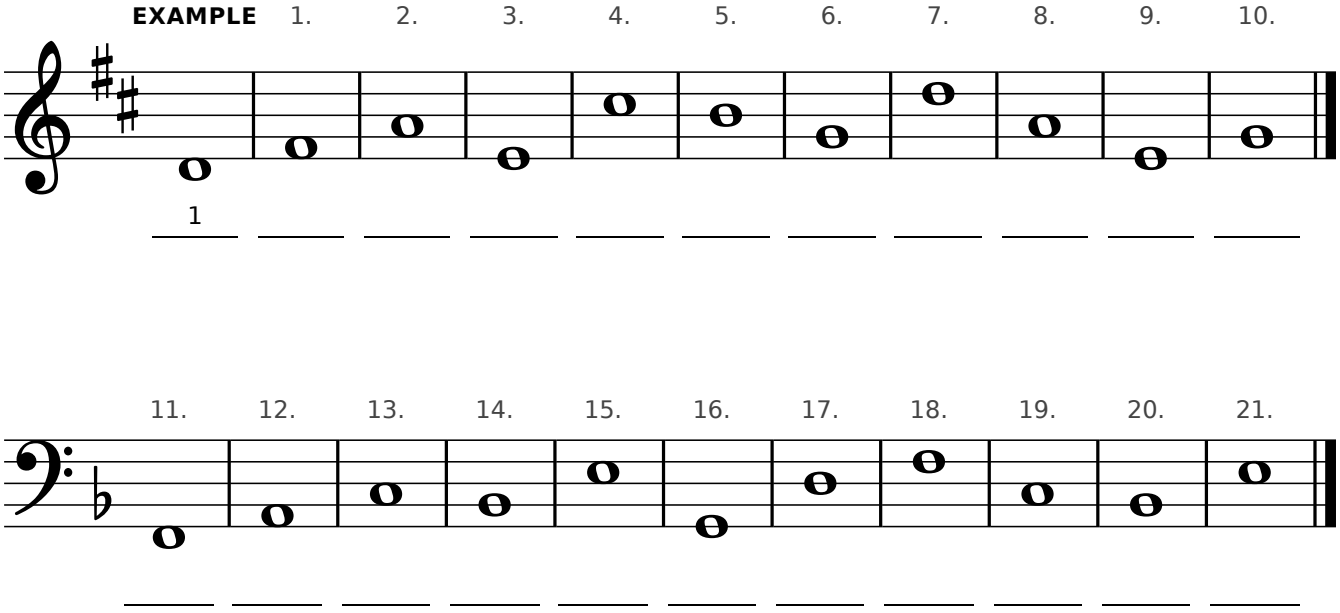
A piece in a major key uses the notes of that key's scale, and it usually begins and ends on notes of the tonic chord (Chapter 19). To find the key of a piece, read the key signature (Chapter 13), then check the last note of the bass line: it is almost always the tonic.

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Name _____ Date _____

Scale Degrees

A. Number the scale degrees Write the scale degree number under each note of D major.



B. Find the degree Write the letter name of each scale degree.

EXAMPLE Degree 5 of C major: G

2. Degree 4 of D major: _____
4. Degree 2 of F major: _____
6. Degree 5 of E♭ major: _____
8. Degree 4 of F major: _____
1. Degree 3 of G major: _____
3. Degree 7 of A major: _____
5. Degree 6 of B♭ major: _____
7. Degree 7 of D major: _____
9. Degree 3 of A major: _____

C. Degree names Write the degree name, or the letter name asked for.

EXAMPLE Degree 1: tonic

2. Degree 4: _____
4. Dominant of D major: _____
6. Leading tone of G major: _____
8. Leading tone of A major: _____
1. Degree 5: _____
3. Degree 7: _____
5. Tonic of E♭ major: _____
7. Subdominant of F major: _____
9. Dominant of B♭ major: _____

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